



KNOX GRAMMAR SCHOOL

2025 Trial HSC Examination

English Extension 1

General Instructions:

- Reading time – 10 minutes
- Working time – 2 hours
- Write using black pen
- Write your response to each **Section** in a **NEW** Writing Booklet
- Attach a student number barcode to the front page of every booklet you use

Total marks: 50

Section 1 – 25 Marks (pages 2 - 3)

- Attempt Question 1
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section 2 – 25 Marks (pages 4-8)

- Attempt one question from questions 2(a) – 2(e)
- Allow about 1 hour for this section

Section I: Common Module — Literary Worlds

25 marks

Attempt Question 1

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- ☒ demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - ☒ craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
-

Question 1 (25 marks)

Read the extracts and then answer the questions that follow.

Text 1

They drove out of the town at half past eight in the morning.

The paved road was dry, a splendid April sun was shedding warmth, but there was still snow in the ditches and in the woods. Winter, evil, dark, long, had ended so recently; spring had arrived suddenly; but neither the warmth nor the languid, transparent woods, warmed by the breath of spring, nor the black flocks flying in the fields over huge puddles that were like lakes, nor this marvellous, immeasurably deep sky, into which it seemed that one would plunge with such joy, offered anything new and interesting to Marya Vasilyevna, who was sitting in the cart. She had been teaching school for thirteen years, and in the course of all those years she had gone to the town for her salary countless times; and whether it was spring, as now, or a rainy autumn evening, or winter, it was all the same to her, and what she always, invariably, longed for was to reach her destination as soon as possible.

She felt as though she had been living in these parts for a long time, for a hundred years, and it seemed to her that she knew every stone, every tree on the road from the town to her school. Here was her past and her present, and she could imagine no other future than the school, the road to the town and back, and again the school and again the road.

ANTON CHEKHOV (1897) An extract from 'In the Cart'

Question 1 continues on page 3

Text 2

In the first pulse of a story, the writer is like a juggler, throwing bowling pins into the air. The rest of the story is the catching of those pins. At any point in the story, certain pins are up there and we can feel them. We'd better feel them. If not, the story has nothing out of which to make its meaning.

What a story is 'about' is to be found in the curiosity it creates in us, which is a form of caring.

So: What do you care about in this story, so far?

It's Marya.

Now: What is the flavour of that caring? How and where, were you made to care about her?

Of all the people in the world he might have put in this cart, Chekhov has chosen an unhappy woman resisting the charms of springtime. Then he made her unhappy in a particular flavour.

Now that Marya is here, unhappy, the story has become restless.

The story has said of her, "She is unhappy and can't imagine any other life for herself."

And we feel the story preparing itself to say something like, "Well, we'll see about that."

GEORGE SAUNDERS (2021) *A Swim in a Pond in the Rain* (in which four Russians give a master class on writing, reading and life).

- (a) Use the ideas in the extracts to construct a literary world where you position the reader to care deeply about the character's unhappiness.

Your response should draw on your knowledge and understanding of the module Literary Worlds.

10 marks

- (b) Critically reflect on how your creative choices in part (a) have been directly shaped by Texts 1 and 2 and your study of literary worlds.

15 marks

End of Question 1

Section II: Electives

25 marks

Attempt ONE question from Questions 2(a) – 2(e) (25 marks)

Allow about 1 hour for this section

Your answer will be assessed on how well you:

- Demonstrate an understanding of the ideas and values of Literary Worlds and how they are shaped and reflected in texts
 - Craft a sustained composition appropriate to the question demonstrating control of the use of language
-

Question 2(a) - Elective 1: Literary Homelands (25 marks)

‘Chinese-Americans, when you try to understand what things in you are Chinese, how do you separate what is peculiar to childhood, to poverty, insanities, one family, your mother who marked your growing with stories, from what is Chinese? What is Chinese tradition, and what is the movies?’

-Maxine Hong-Kingston, *The Woman Warrior*

To what extent does this view reflect the complexities individuals or communities experience between their connections to ‘homelands’ and their connection with other in, or from, a diverse culture?

In your response refer to TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Elective 1: Literary Homelands are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Aravind Adega, *The White Tiger*
 - -E.M. Forster, *A Passage to India*
 - -Colm Toibin, *Brooklyn*
- * **Poetry**
 - Eileen Chong, *Burning Rice*
 - The prescribed poems are:
 - **Burning Rice*
 - **Mid-autumn Mooncakes*
 - **My Hakka Grandmother*
 - **Shophouse, Victoria Street*
 - **Chinese Ginseng*
 - **Winter Meeting*
 - **Singapore*
- **Drama**
 - Andrew Bovell, *The Secret River* [by Kate Grenville – An adaptation for stage by Andrew Bovell]
- **Film**
 - Sarah Gavron, *Brick Lane*

OR

Question 2(b) – Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval (25 marks)

In representing worlds of upheaval, composers challenge the limitations of traditional literary forms and conventions, reflecting their aspirations for radical political and social change.

Evaluate how this idea is realised in the texts you have studied in your elective.

In your response refer to TWO of your prescribed texts and TWO texts of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Elective 2: Worlds of Upheaval are:

- **Prose fiction**
 - Elizabeth Gaskell, *North and South*
 - Mary Shelley, *Frankenstein*
 - Madeleine Thien, *Do Not Say We Have Nothing*
- **Poetry**
 - Seamus Heaney, *Opened Ground: Poems 1966-1996*

The prescribed poems are:
Digging
The Strand at Lough Beg
Casualty
Funeral Rites
Whatever You Say Say Nothing
Tryptich
- **Drama**
 - Samuel Beckett, *Waiting for Godot*
- **Film**
 - Fritz Lang, *Metropolis*

Question 2 continues on page 6

Question 2 continued

Question 2I - Intersecting Worlds (25 marks)

‘Well, let us talk ’bout God, but I’m still adrift. Trying to chase that old white man out of my head. I bee so busy thinking ’bout him I never truly notice nothing God make. Not a blade of corn (how it do that?) not the colour purple (where it come from?). Not the little wildflowers. Nothing.’

-Alice Walker, *The Color Purple*

To what extent have representations of the natural world brought out the value of nature as a transformative experience for individuals?

In your response, refer to the passage quoted above, TWO prescribed texts and at least ONE related text of your own choosing.

The prescribed texts for Elective 5: Intersecting Worlds are:

- **Prose Fiction**
 - Melissa Harrison, *Clay*
 - Alex Miller, *Journey to the Stone Country*
 - Annie Proulx, *The Shipping News*
- **Nonfiction**
 - Tim Winton, *Island Home*
- **Poetry**
 - William Wordsworth, *William Wordsworth: The Major Works*

The prescribed poems are:

- *Lines written a few miles above Tintern Abbey*
 - *Three years she grew in the sun and shower*
 - *My heart leaps up when I behold*
 - *Resolution and Independence*
 - *The world is too much with us*
 - *Ode (‘There was a time’)*
 - *The Solitary Reaper*
 - *The prelude (1805) – Book One, lines 1-67, 271-441*
- **Film**
 - Daniel Nettheim, *The Hunter*

End of Question 2

End of paper